

Classroom Teaching Observation

Professor:	David Brocker	Observation Date & Time:	March 4, 8AM
Observer:	Marya Howell-Carter	Duration of Observation:	1:15
Course Number:	PSY 360	Building / Room:	Gleeson 233
Course Name:	Research Methods	Number of Students:	10 (5 come late)
Lesson Topic:	Reliability/Validity	Pre-Observation Date:	2.17.26
Class Format:	☒ Lecture ☐ Laboratory ☐ Studio ☐ Clinic	Post-Observation Date:	4.2.26
Topic Expert Present?	☐ No ☒ Yes – Name of Faculty Member: Dr. Michael Goodstone		

	Category & Description	Observation Comments
1	Knowledge and Delivery of Subject: Instructor demonstrates a high degree of knowledge and confidence with respect to the subject matter being taught in this lesson.	The professor is very knowledgeable about the content of the class as evidenced by the preparation of the presentation, the excellent examples he provides, the way that he, Socratically, draws information from the students, and the ways that he responds to student questions.
2	Class Preparation & Organization: Instructor is well-organized and prepared. An introduction to the lesson precedes the lesson; a summary is done at the end of the lesson.	Class began right on time with a good review of the prior content that lead up to this class. This review was highly engaging, prepped the students to go on to new material, and helped them understand how all of the content is interconnected. The professor then provided a screen with the goals for the new material. At the end of the class, Professor Brocker provided a review in the form of "Key Takeaways".
3	Rapport & Interaction with Students: Instructor holds interest of students; is respectful, fair, and impartial. Provides feedback, interacts with students, strives to draw students into discussion, shows enthusiasm and professionalism.	The professor is welcoming, supportive, and respectful. His general demeanor is self-deprecating and humorous. He acknowledges and emphasizes his own flaws, fallibility, and shortcomings which all effectively model the desirability of making mistakes and learning from errors.
4	Classroom Management: Instructor demonstrates effective classroom management skills, and maintains a classroom environment conducive to learning.	The professor is very effective in engaging the students and maintaining an effective learning atmosphere. The classroom is warm and supportive. The professor encourages near constant participation. The only thing I would note is that half the class, though seemingly listening and understanding, were relatively uninvolved. Maybe intentionally reach out to those students periodically to ensure they really are following.
5	Communication: Instructions and explanations are clear and at an appropriate level for this course. Student questions are clearly answered in polite manner. Instructor speaks and projects voice clearly.	Explanations were clear and effectively illustrated. See the feedback below about some ideas for slightly more effective examples for some discrete moments.
6	Use of Instructional Resources: Instructor uses relevant teaching methods, materials, techniques, and technology as appropriate to this specific lesson.	The PPT is excellent--well prepared, visually effective, dynamic, illustrative, demonstrative, uses good images that help to emphasize the concept. In some really great meta-cognitive moments, the professor actually brings student attention to the ways that the images were designed to support the content and were funny or strange. They were easy to take notes from. They were engaging--always something to do or think about. This was not a lecture--it was an interactive discussion.

Observer's Overall Comments:

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Please write a summary (400 – 800 words). You may expand upon any of the categories 1 – 6 on the previous page of this form. Base your comments on your overall impression of the instructor's teaching effectiveness, perceived strengths, and any suggestions for improvement. Please limit your comments to what you directly observed during this class session.

Class summary: The faculty member started with a quick reference to prior lecture: "how did we get here" as a way of review. How many claims do we have? Students readily respond with the various types of "claims" they have made thus far. Three claims: Frequency, Association, Cause. Four validities: Internal (tells us about causality), External (how much can we generalize), Construct, Statistical. Subjective validities: Face, Content (has all the content we expect to see), Criterion, Convergent, Divergent. Reliability measures: test retest, inter-rater, internal. Following the review, the professor provides a 5 goal summary of what they are going to do in this unit. Students very willing to participate in the review, seem to have a good beginning understanding.

New content: What is a survey? students are able to identify characteristics and problems with potential survey questions and answers. Open-ended questions: pros and cons. Showed some data, taken from a previous class, to illustrate. Effectively demonstrates the challenges of open ended questions. Discussed the dilemma of the forced-choice format. Introduced Likert scale: pros/cons. Semantic differential format: end points are anchored by adjectives (but what's in between is not clear). Leading questions. Construct validity in relation to surveys/questions. Writing well-worded questions: worded as naturally as possible; no double barreled questions. Some questions assume a position from the start: How dissatisfied are you with... Want to make questions more cognitively simple--when there is confusion, possible reduction in construct validity. Avoid double negatives. Emotionally charged questions affect responses (e.g., how devastating was this experience...). Question order matters. concerns about consequences matter. Survey shortcuts: response sets (choosing responses based on something other than truth: e.g., take a survey haphazardly.) Acquiescence: just saying yes all the time. Fence sitting: basically not endorsing an opinion (N/A or no opinion). Social desirability (responding in ways that make you look good) and faking bad (answering in ways that make you appear to be more aggressive, deviant, nastier, etc.). Encouraging accurate responses. After concluding this unit of survey research, the professor began the unit on observational research by defining and describing. Then began to describe the strengths and weaknesses of observational research: Observer bias, Observer effects. Gives great examples of real research/real world phenomena to ask students questions and draw out their understanding of observer effects and bias. Ends with the ethics of observational research.

This was truly an excellent class—it was not a lecture, but rather a dynamic, Socratically-led, conversation. One of the nicest parts of the class was that Professor Bocker does a nice job continually referring back to prior lectures for examples and to make connections. Professor Bocker prepared a beautifully-constructed, minimalist, presentation that encouraged critical thinking, involvement, and minimal note-taking. There was good involvement that increased as the class proceeded, though there were 5-6 students who were most vocal. I might deliberately reach to other students to make sure they are keeping up.

Professor Bocker asked that this observer bring special attention to the examples he uses and how they "hit" (whether they seem to resonate with the students). While it was my sense that most examples DID "hit", there is room to consider other examples/illustrations. ALL of his examples were solid, accurate, interesting and appropriate, but some could be more "relevant". For example: "interrater reliability". The professor mentioned being in an experiment himself and two researchers needing to decide whether the participants behavior meets study criteria...while totally true and accurate, this may not resonate with a college student who has not participated in research. Consider using something they may have experienced like the SAT/ACT essay. These are subjective tests with multiple raters, for which they provide training and a scoring rubric to increase interrater reliability. OR, receiving a diagnosis at the doctor and seeking a second opinion (which we hope is consistent!). OR We just had the Olympics where the French judge was criticized for being a significant outlier in figure skating—interrater reliability was poor. I have no doubt Professor Bocker will create relevant, interesting examples because of his dedication to his teaching and student learning. This was an outstanding class with all of the elements we hope to see in an effective classroom--rapport and engagement chief among them.

Addendums with specific evaluation criteria for clinics, labs and studios may be attached if necessary.

Please attach any documents provided by the instructor from the pre-observation that you feel would be relevant to include with this observation.

The signatures of both the observer and the instructor are required. By signing below, the instructor acknowledges having met with the observer in-person, having discussed the observation, and having received a copy of this observation. A signature does not indicate that the instructor necessarily agrees with the observation. If the instructor disagrees with any aspect of this observation, he or she may discuss it with the observer, and has the right to write a rebuttal, which would require the same distribution outlined below. The observation and the rebuttal will become part of the official faculty file.

Signature of Observer:



Date Signed:

3/9/26

Signature of Instructor:



Date Signed:

3/9/2026

Form Updated: 10/01/2018

Distribution: Original with signatures retained by instructor after the mandatory in-person post-observation meeting. Observer retains one copy and subsequent copies are to be distributed by the department secretary as follows: (1) Department Chair; (2) Department CCTA Chair; (3) School Dean; (4) Provost.